

IELTS Reading Test — Results

Score: 26 / 40 Band: Band 6 — Competent User Total time: 55:45

Passage	Score	Time
The Origins of Weather Forecasting	9/13	31:29
From Princes to Paupers	11/13	8:07
Language Diversity	6/14	16:08

Question Type	Score
Multiple Choice	1/5
Matching	1/3
Short Answer	8/12
Yes / No / Not Given	4/6
Multiple Choice (Two Answers)	3/4
Paragraph Matching	4/5
True / False / Not Given	5/5

Suggestions

Multiple Choice (1/5): Eliminate clearly wrong options and watch for distractors that slightly change the meaning.

Matching (1/3): Locate each option in the text and underline the exact lines before deciding.

Your weakest passage was Language Diversity (6/14). Re-read it in Study Mode to see where the answers are located.

You spent over 31 minutes on The Origins of Weather Forecasting. Aim for about 20 minutes per passage so all three get equal time.

Q	Result	Your answer	Correct	Explanation
1	Correct	FALSE	FALSE	Predicting the weather had gained a reputation similar to astrology or fortune-telling, and forecasters had become a national joke.
2	Correct	TRUE	TRUE	His background was faultless, most famously his captaining of HMS Beagle on Darwin's voyage.
3	Correct	NOT GIVEN	NOT GIVEN	The text says he secured the job but gives no information about other applicants.
4	Correct	FALSE	FALSE	The suggestion for a weather forecast was met with laughter from the other MPs.
5	Correct	TRUE	TRUE	Barometer readings and the invention of the electric telegraph and Morse code made it the right moment.
6	Correct	instruments	instruments	FitzRoy issued ships with standardised instruments which allowed for accurate weather reports.
7	Correct	ports	ports	From London, FitzRoy could telegraph warnings to ports on the coast.
8	Wrong	ingenious	flags	An ingenious system of flags was hoisted up high for passing ships to read.
9	Correct	lifeboat	lifeboat	It represented the biggest advance in shipping safety after the introduction of the lifeboat.
10	Correct	island	island	Queen Victoria got forecasts for the crossing to an island off the south coast she liked to visit.
11	Wrong	vessels	owners	The owners of fishing vessels were not supportive, as forecasts often caused delays for them.

Q	Result	Your answer	Correct	Explanation
12	Wrong	shipping	name	An area of sea was given his name in the shipping forecast.
13	Wrong	dearly	book	Late in his life he published a book about weather forecasting, recognised by other scientists.
14	Correct	G	G	Paragraph G notes that not all his portraits are successful – some have a doll-like stiffness.
15	Wrong	G	E	Paragraph E contrasts Goya with Gainsborough, who resented portraiture as an economically necessary chore.
16	Correct	A	A	Paragraph A states there are no pure landscapes in Goya's work.
17	Correct	D	D	Paragraph D describes how, after becoming pintor de cámara, he bought a two-wheeled gig and wrote about his new way of living.
18	Correct	A	A	Paragraph A explains how his combined work forms a portrait in the round of Spain itself through a period of great upheaval.
19	Wrong	B	A, C	They featured lively civilians and labourers he observed (A) and were used to develop techniques for his future works (C).
20	Correct	C	A, C	They featured lively civilians and labourers he observed (A) and were used to develop techniques for his future works (C).
21	Correct	C	C, D	He generally avoided using the same pose (C) and paid very close attention to the background (D).
22	Correct	D	C, D	He generally avoided using the same pose (C) and paid very close attention to the background (D).
23	Correct	commission	commission	The portrait of Charles IV was the most important commission of his career.
24	Correct	butcher	butcher	A French visitor had likened Charles and his queen to a butcher and his wife.
25	Correct	doctor	doctor	In the 1820 double portrait, Goya is tended by his doctor, Dr Arrieta.
26	Correct	kindness	kindness	Arrieta stands for man's innate kindness.
27	Correct	YES	YES	For five decades the idea of universal grammar prevailed and influenced linguistics, psychology and cognitive science.
28	Correct	NO	NO	The writer stresses that there are almost always exceptions to identified universal rules.
29	Wrong	NO	YES	The claim that Straits Salish lacks distinct nouns or verbs is described as more controversial.
30	Wrong	YES	NOT GIVEN	The writer does not comment on whether the search for new universals has stopped.
31	Correct	NO	NO	The writer says that if they are correct, our brains have differences depending on the language environment we grew up in.
32	Correct	YES	YES	Every time a language becomes extinct, humanity loses an important piece of diversity.
33	Wrong	D	A	They argue there are no absolutely universal traits, only tendencies, and each language is a complex system shaped by many factors.
34	Wrong	B	C	Widely shared elements may result from a particularly human kind of reasoning – a shared way of perceiving the world.
35	Correct	C	C	It is offered as a possible cause of the sound systems of some Indigenous Australian languages.
36	Wrong	D	B	No one has summarised these ideas quite as persuasively, generating widespread enthusiasm.
37	Wrong	C	D	The passage sets the theory of universal grammar against the diversity-based view of Evans and Levinson.
38	Wrong	C	B	Arrernte has VC syllables but no CV syllables – a sequence of sounds predicted by UG.
39	Correct	A	A	Lao has no adjectives – words of a certain grammatical type.

Q	Result	Your answer	Correct	Explanation
40	Wrong	E	D	Piraha is said to lack recursion, the language feature regarded as the most basic.